



Investigation report

Rejected take-off and runway overrun, Tarlton Springs - Standard investigation

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INVESTIGATION WORKFLOW SUITE

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Executive summary

What happened

On 18/06/2026 at about 17:30 local time (07:30 UTC), Saltbush Air SB512, a 50-seat twin-turboprop registered VH-SBQ, was taking off from runway 09 at Tarlton Springs Aerodrome after last light. The first officer called two kangaroos on the runway two seconds after V1, and the captain rejected the take-off at 118 kt, 6 kt above V1. About one second later the No. 2 propeller and right main gear struck both animals. The aircraft left the sealed runway end at about 21 kt and stopped upright on the extended centreline, 62 m into the 90 m runway end safety area and 28 m short of the end of the prepared area.

Outcome

There were no serious injuries among the 44 passengers, 2 flight crew and 1 cabin crew. One cabin crew member reported bruising during disembarkation. No evacuation was commanded, and passengers left by the forward airstair. The aircraft was substantially damaged:

- three No. 2 propeller blades were damaged beyond limits, and the engine required a shock-load inspection
- the right main gear doors were distorted
- both right main tyres deflated through their fuse plugs at 84% of certified brake energy
- the lower right fuselage was punctured.

Two kangaroos were killed. The aerodrome closed for 4 hours 20 minutes, and the evening Tarlton Springs service was suspended.

Why it happened

The scheduled accelerate-stop margin of 67 m assumed a stop begun at or before V1 with reverse thrust on both engines. The late reject very likely consumed that margin. The strike then removed No. 2 reverse thrust, and deceleration was about 15% below the certified value. Both were needed to reach the runway end.

Repair of a failed section of the northern perimeter fence had been deferred for three budget cycles, which very likely contributed. An animal pad through the fence lay 138 m before the first carcass, on the same side of the runway. The departure fell in the period of most kangaroo movement in the aerodrome's sighting log, which likely contributed. No runway inspection was requested, although the aerodrome would have carried one out on request, and this likely contributed. No document prompted either crew member to request one.

The operator's rejected take-off training presented only aircraft system failures, three of them below V1, and this likely contributed to the decision to reject. The captain stated that he knew the rule and departed from it deliberately. On that reading the training gap is a fleet finding rather than the cause of this reject, and both readings are carried.

The crew reached maximum braking in 2 seconds, against a fleet mean of 3.2 seconds, which reduced the extent of the overrun.

Safety issues

- The operator required a runway inspection after last light only at aerodromes listed in Appendix 8A, and listing required a reported strike there. This very likely contributed. Eleven recorded sightings of kangaroos on the sealed surface could not put Tarlton Springs on the list.

- The evening service was approved as a schedule change without reopening route risk assessment RRA-041, which restricted Tarlton Springs to daylight operations. This likely contributed.
- AS-139 required a documented wildlife hazard management plan only above a size threshold that Tarlton Springs did not meet, so the aerodrome was not in breach. This likely contributed, though less firmly than the other factors, because a plan would not by itself have funded the fence.
- The fence repair deferral and the rejected take-off training scope described above.
- Two cabin floor proximity lighting segments were dark because a common ballast had failed, a defect the pre-flight test does not detect. This was not established as contributing but increased risk.

The crew's long fifth-sector duty did not contribute, because the recorded data contradicted each mechanism by which fatigue could have acted. It remains a scheduling exposure that increased risk. Whether runway edge lighting intensity reduced detection of the animals could not be determined.

Safety action

- The operator listed Tarlton Springs in Appendix 8A by temporary revision on 26/06/2026.
- The aerodrome operator funded the fence replacement for 09/2026 and installed a temporary electric wire on 25/06/2026.
- The investigation recommended that the operator base Appendix 8A listing on wildlife exposure rather than a reported strike, and add a route risk assessment trigger for any aerodrome first operated into after last light.

Event overview

On 18/06/2026, Saltbush Air SB512, a 50-seat twin-turboprop registered VH-SBQ, was scheduled to depart Tarlton Springs Aerodrome on the last scheduled sector of the day. The flight was bound for Sydney. On board were 44 passengers, 2 flight crew and 1 cabin crew. All times in this section are UTC. Local time was UTC plus 10 hours, so the occurrence took place at about 17:30 local.

The flight and crew

The pilot in command had 8,410 hours total, 2,140 hours on type and 3 years 1 month in command. The first officer had 1,655 hours total, 405 hours on type and 14 months with the company. The first officer had flown two previous sectors into Tarlton Springs, both in daylight, on 09/01/2026 and 17/02/2026. The first officer was the pilot flying for the take-off.

SB512 was the fifth sector of the crew's duty. That sector had been added on the morning of 18/06/2026 when the rostered crew reported unfit. The duty record shows a sign-on at 06:30 local and a planned finish at 18:35 local, a duty of 12 hours 05 minutes against a permitted maximum of 12 hours 30 minutes for five sectors with that sign-on. The pilot in command's interview background records the duty as beginning at 05:10 local. That difference is not resolved.

The aerodrome before the departure

The aerodrome operator carried out one movement area inspection that day, at 21:35 on 17/06/2026 (07:35 local on 18/06/2026), before the first scheduled arrival. It recorded the movement area as clear. No further runway inspection was carried out or requested before SB512 departed.

The aerodrome kept a paper wildlife sighting log in its office. From 01/2025 to 06/2026 it held 46 entries. Of these, 41 recorded kangaroos on or near the movement area, and 38 of those 41 fell between one hour before and two hours after last light. Eleven entries recorded animals on the sealed surface of runway 09/27. The log was not reported to any operator, and the aerodrome reporting officer confirmed that no airline had ever asked for it. The pilot in command later reported seeing kangaroos on the strip at Tarlton Springs in the evening several times. The first officer reported that the flight plan, charts, ERSA entry and company aerodrome brief page she had reviewed did not mention animals.

The doors closed at 07:16, 40 minutes behind schedule. The aerodrome was in darkness. The tower was open and was rostered to close at 18:00 local. [NOT ESTABLISHED: time of last light and end of civil twilight at Tarlton Springs on 18/06/2026]

Take-off clearance and the take-off roll

At 07:29:04 the pilot in command reported ready for runway 09. At 07:29:10 the tower cleared SB512 for take-off, passing the wind as "zero nine zero at six". No runway inspection was offered by the tower or requested by the crew. No wildlife transmission appears on the tower channel in the preceding 90 minutes. At 07:29:22 the pilot in command remarked that the "lights are on" and handed the take-off to the first officer.

The calculated V1 was 112 kt, based on a weight of 20,800 kg, flap 10, a dry runway 09 and a 5 kt headwind component. Power was set at 07:30:02, with torque at 98.4% and 98.5% on the No. 1 and No. 2 engines. The recorded data showed both engines within 0.1% of each other with no caution, warning or exceedance, and a headwind component of 4 to 6 kt throughout the roll. The pilot in command called "Eighty knots" at 07:30:15 and "V one" at 07:30:29, at 112 kt.

The sighting and the reject

At 07:30:31, two seconds after V1 and at 116 kt, the first officer called "roos, roos, on the left". Two kangaroos were crossing from the northern side of the runway towards the south. The first officer estimated the range at first sight at around 200 m and said it could have been less. Shortly after the occurrence she told the pilot in command on the flight deck that the animals "came out of the dark on the left of the strip" and that she "had them for - I don't know, two seconds. Maybe less." The pilot in command responded, "I never had them. I was heads-in on the engine page after V one." In his report, the pilot in command described looking up after the call and seeing two large animals already on the sealed surface.

At 07:30:32 the pilot in command called "Stopping. I have control." The take-off was rejected at 118 kt, six knots and three seconds past V1. The power levers reached flight idle within 0.6 seconds. Reconstruction from recorded groundspeed placed the aircraft 1,152 m along runway 09 at that moment, with 695 m of sealed surface remaining. In his report the pilot in command described the reject as a decision made in about a second. He judged that continuing would have put the aircraft airborne at night with damage he could not assess.

The strike and the stop

At 07:30:33, about one second after the reject, the aircraft struck the animals. The recorders captured a lateral acceleration spike of 0.31 g right and a vertical spike of 1.48 g. The occurrence notification records that the aircraft struck both animals, with the right main landing gear and the No. 2 propeller taking the impact. The pilot in command's report described striking at least one animal. Two carcasses were later recovered at 1,188 m and 1,221 m from the runway 09 threshold, and animal tissue was found in two No. 2 propeller blade roots. Three No. 2 propeller blades were damaged beyond repairable limits.

Maximum braking was established at 07:30:34, two seconds after the decision. The operator's fleet mean from decision to maximum braking is 3.2 seconds. Anti-skid was active on all four wheels. At 07:30:36 the pilot in command selected reverse. Only the No. 1 propeller responded. The No. 2 propeller RPM was decaying and its reverse interlock did not make. The pilot in command called "Max brakes, max brakes." The mean deceleration between 07:30:34 and 07:30:44 was 2.6 m/s², about 15% below the value used in the certified accelerate-stop data for that weight and runway condition, which assumes symmetric reverse. At 07:30:47 the pilot in command said, "We're not stopping on it."

At 07:30:51 the aircraft left the sealed end of runway 09 at about 21 kt. In the graded gravel of the runway end safety area, deceleration fell to 1.9 m/s². The aircraft stopped at 07:30:57, 62 m into the 90 m runway end safety area, upright and on the extended centreline, with the nose wheel in gravel. That point was 28 m short of the end of the prepared safety area. The total stopping distance from 118 kt was 757 m. Continuous tyre marks ran from 1,160 m to the runway end.

Immediate aftermath

At 07:31:04 the pilot in command set the parking brake, noted that there were no fire indications, and stated, "I'm not evacuating." The first officer agreed. Both engines were shut down at 07:31:26. At 07:31:34 the pilot in command told the cabin to remain seated. At 07:31:54 he advised the tower of the overrun and requested activation of the aerodrome emergency plan and a vehicle. The tower activated the plan at 07:32:10 and dispatched a vehicle. No assistance for injuries was requested at that stage.

No evacuation was commanded and no slides were deployed. The cabin crew member was instructed to hold. The sound of the forward airstair operating was recorded at 07:34:40, and passengers disembarked onto the gravel by that airstair with the main cabin lights on. The occurrence notification records the disembarkation as occurring 4 minutes 8 seconds after the aircraft stopped. The timeline places the same 4 minutes 8 seconds between 07:34:40 and 07:38:48.

During the disembarkation the first officer noticed unlit sections of the aft cabin floor proximity strip. Aerodrome staff attended with a vehicle and there was no fire.

There were no serious injuries. One cabin crew member reported bruising during the disembarkation. Both right main tyres deflated through their fuse plugs, with brake energy calculated at 84% of the certified maximum. The right main gear doors were distorted and the lower right fuselage was punctured. Two kangaroos were killed. The aerodrome closed for 4 hours 20 minutes. Both flight crew were stood down and tested for drugs and alcohol, with negative results. The evening Tarlton Springs service was suspended pending the investigation.

Analysis

Introduction

The overrun had two causal paths that met at a single point. The first path ran from the presence of the animals on the runway, through the pilot in command's decision to reject the take-off after V1, to a stop that began later and at a higher speed than the scheduled accelerate-stop figures assume. The second path ran from the same animals, through the strike on the No. 2 propeller and the right main landing gear, to a stop with reverse available on one engine only. The two paths converged in a deceleration shortfall that carried the aircraft 62 m into the runway end safety area.

Upstream of the animals, several conditions shaped the occurrence. These were the departure time relative to last light, the condition of the northern perimeter fence, and the absence of a runway inspection before the roll. Those conditions in turn arose from the operator's wildlife procedures, its management of the change that introduced the evening service, the aerodrome's deferred fence repair, and the threshold in the aerodrome standard that governs wildlife planning.

This analysis takes each factor under the heading it belongs to. It states the likelihood that each factor existed and the likelihood that it contributed. It distinguishes contributing safety factors from other factors that increased risk without contributing to this occurrence. It also discusses one matter that was examined and could not be resolved. It closes with the hypotheses that were tested and excluded.

People

The decision to reject the take-off after V1

The recorded data established the timing of the decision without ambiguity. V1 was called at 07:30:29 at 112 kt. The first officer's sighting call followed at 07:30:31 at 116 kt. At 07:30:32 the pilot in command called "Stopping. I have control." Both power levers reached flight idle within 0.6 seconds, at 118 kt. The reject therefore began three seconds and six knots after V1. The first officer responded "You have control" in the same second. The whole decision was made and announced in a single exchange.

The applicable procedure was Operations Manual Part B 4.6.4. It states: "At or above V1 the take-off shall be continued. The decision to continue is made before V1 is reached." The pilot in command gave his reasons in interview and in his air safety report. He judged that rotating into two large animals would leave the aircraft airborne at night with damage he could not assess, over country that offered no usable option. He chose the risk whose end he could see. He also stated plainly that the decision was not in accordance with the procedure.

The decision should be understood in the setting in which it was made. The pilot in command did not see the animals himself before calling the reject. The CVR records him telling the first officer after the stop, "I never had them. I was heads-in on the engine page after V one." That is where the procedure places the monitoring pilot at that stage of the roll. He acted on the first officer's call, in about a second, at night, with the animals already on the sealed surface ahead.

The scheduled accelerate-stop distance required was 1,780 m against an accelerate-stop distance available of 1,847 m, a margin of 67 m. That figure assumes the stop begins at or before V1. Distance reconstruction from recorded groundspeed placed the aircraft 1,152 m along runway 09 when the reject began, with 695 m of sealed surface remaining. Beginning the stop six knots and three seconds later than the scheduled figures assume eroded the 67 m margin before any loss of reverse thrust was counted. Rejecting at 118 kt rather than continuing was the decision that committed the aircraft to a stop from that point.

This decision was itself downstream of other factors. The animals were on the runway because of conditions discussed under Environment and Organisation. The decision was made without any training or guidance for an obstruction at that speed, which is discussed under Procedures. The decision is a contributing factor. It is not the whole explanation, and it should not be read as one.

It was virtually certain that the take-off was rejected 6 kt above V1, and extremely likely that this contributed to the runway overrun.

No runway inspection was requested before the first departure after last light

No runway inspection was requested before SB512 departed. Neither the CVR nor the tower's recorded audio contains any request for an inspection, any offer of one, or any mention of wildlife before departure. The aerodrome's daily inspection log for 18/06/2026 records one inspection, at 07:35 local before the first arrival, with the movement area recorded as clear. No further inspection was carried out or requested that day.

An inspection was available. Aerodrome Manual 6.3 provides for inspections outside the scheduled time when the reporting officer or a pilot in command requests one. The reporting officer confirmed that an inspection would have been carried out if asked.

Both crew members stated that they did not consider requesting one. The pilot in command had expected Tarlton Springs to be on the operator's Appendix 8A list of wildlife-active aerodromes and was surprised to learn that it was not. As discussed under Procedures, only an Appendix 8A listing would have required the request. At every other aerodrome, Operations Manual Part A 8.14.3 states that "no specific action is required". No document directed either crew member to consider an inspection at Tarlton Springs. The omission is best understood as the absence of a prompt, not as a lapse by either individual.

An inspection would very likely have covered the section of runway from 1,050 m to 1,250 m. Both the animal pad through the fence and the two carcasses were found in that section. Aerodrome staff disperse animals when they find them. An inspection would therefore have put a vehicle on the runway in the 20 minutes before the roll, in the area where the animals later appeared. However, an inspection completed some minutes before departure cannot guarantee that the runway remains clear when the roll begins. For that reason the influence of this omission is put at likely rather than higher.

It was virtually certain that no runway inspection was requested before the first departure after last light, and likely that this contributed to the presence of the animals on the runway at the time of the roll.

The stop after the decision

Once the decision was made, the stop was carried out quickly and well. The power levers reached flight idle 0.6 seconds after the decision. Maximum braking was established at 07:30:34, 2 seconds after the decision. The operator's recorded fleet mean from decision to maximum braking is 3.2 seconds. Anti-skid was active on all four wheels throughout. Brake energy reached 84% of the certified maximum with no brake fire.

Reverse was selected on the No. 1 engine at 07:30:36, 4 seconds after the decision. The No. 2 reverse was unavailable because its propeller had been damaged in the strike. The CVR records the pilot in command identifying that loss immediately and calling for maximum braking. During the stop the first officer called the decreasing speed and the approaching runway end.

The aircraft left the sealed surface at about 21 kt. It stopped 62 m into the 90 m runway end safety area, upright and on the extended centreline. The investigation estimated that a stop begun at the fleet mean response time would have carried the aircraft a further 30 to 40 m.

After the aircraft stopped, the pilot in command confirmed there were no fire indications and decided not to evacuate. He then arranged a precautionary disembarkation by the forward airstair. The response to the reject reduced the severity of the outcome. It should be recorded alongside the finding that the reject itself was outside procedure.

It was virtually certain that maximum braking and No. 1 reverse were applied without delay, and very likely that this reduced the severity of the overrun.

Duty period and timing (other factor that increased risk)

SB512 was the crew's fifth sector of the day. The crew signed on at 06:30 local. The fifth sector had been added that morning when the rostered crew reported unfit. The occurrence was at 17:30 local, 11 hours 00 minutes into a duty planned to finish at 18:35 local. That gave a planned duty of 12 hours 05 minutes against a limit of 12 hours 30 minutes for five sectors from that sign-on. The aircraft departed 40 minutes behind schedule. Both crew members described themselves in interview as tired but not struggling. The pilot in command said he would have declined a further sector, and that he was fully alert for the two seconds that mattered.

The investigation tested whether the duty affected the occurrence. On one side, 11 hours into a five-sector day is within the range where degraded decision making is expected. The schedule was late, and the crew were working to finish. On the other side, the recorded data contradicts each mechanism through which fatigue would have had to act. The pilot in command took 0.6 seconds to reach flight idle and 2 seconds to establish maximum braking, which is at the fast end of the fleet's distribution. There was no error of omission during the roll. The one decision the duty might plausibly have affected was whether to request a runway inspection. That decision was never available to be affected, because no document prompted either crew member to consider it. Fatigue cannot be found to have caused the omission of a step that neither crew member was asked to take. The duty did not influence this occurrence.

The duty pattern remains significant beyond this occurrence. The evening Tarlton Springs rotation routinely places the last sector near the end of a long duty. The aerodrome has no company engineering, no alternate within 200 nm at night, and no crewing resilience. A single crew member reporting unfit can turn a four-sector day into a five-sector day on the morning of operation. This is a standing exposure built into the schedule and will recur.

It was virtually certain that the occurrence sector was the fifth sector of the day, 11 hours into duty and 40 minutes behind schedule. It was unlikely that this contributed to the occurrence, and likely that it increased risk.

Environment

Departure in the hour after last light

On 18/06/2026 sunset at Tarlton Springs was at 16:58 local and civil twilight ended at 17:25 local. The roll began at 17:30 local, 32 minutes after sunset and 5 minutes after the end of civil twilight. Moonrise was not until 22:41, and the moon was a waning crescent, 14% illuminated. There was no natural ambient light on the strip and no town lighting within sight. The investigator visited the site at the same time of day on 23/06/2026. That visit confirmed that the unlit graded strip either side of the sealed surface cannot be seen from the runway centreline.

The departure time also coincided with the aerodrome's period of peak wildlife activity. The aerodrome's sighting log for 01/2025 to 06/2026 holds 41 entries for kangaroos on or near the movement area. Of these, 38 fall between one hour before and two hours after last light. The log is a paper register, so its completeness cannot be verified. For that reason the existence of this condition is put at extremely likely rather than virtually certain.

The light condition had a direct effect on what the crew could see. The animals were not seen until they were on the lit sealed surface. The first officer described them as coming out of the dark on the left of the strip. She first saw them at a range she estimated at around 200 m. Her call came two seconds after V1. Taken together, the light condition and the timing meant that animals approaching from the strip could not be seen in time to be acted on before V1.

On its own, a departure shortly after last light is unremarkable. Here it placed the roll inside the aerodrome's recorded peak of kangaroo movement, in a light condition in which nothing off the sealed surface could be seen. That combination is what made the missing inspection matter.

It was extremely likely that the departure took place in the hour after last light, during the peak of kangaroo movement at the aerodrome, and likely that this contributed to the animals being on the runway undetected until after V1.

Two kangaroos on the sealed surface

The presence of the animals on the runway is established by three independent pieces of evidence, each sufficient on its own. Two adult kangaroo carcasses were recovered from the northern half of runway 09, at 1,188 m and 1,221 m from the threshold. The first officer's sighting call is recorded on the CVR at 07:30:31. An impact is recorded at 07:30:33. The first officer saw the animals crossing from the northern side of the runway towards the south.

The aerodrome's sighting log shows that this was not an isolated event. Eleven entries record animals on the sealed surface of runway 09/27, all around last light. No inspection had been carried out since 07:35 local that morning.

The geometry points to the animals' likely route onto the runway. The animal pad through the failed northern fence is at the 1,050 m mark, on the same side of the runway as the carcasses at 1,188 m and 1,221 m. The fence is discussed under Organisation.

Both the reject and the strike followed directly from the animals being on the surface. Of all the factors in this occurrence, this is also the one that a single works item, estimated at \$41,000, would have addressed directly.

It was virtually certain that two kangaroos entered the runway strip and moved onto the sealed surface, and extremely likely that this contributed to the occurrence.

Runway edge lighting intensity (unresolved)

The investigation examined whether the intensity of the runway edge lighting reduced the crew's ability to detect the animals. This matter could not be resolved. It is not a finding either way. The investigation assessed it as about as likely as not.

The intensity deviation itself is established. A photometric check was carried out at the investigator's request on 25/06/2026, seven days after the occurrence. It found four northern edge lights between the 900 m and 1,200 m markers at 118% to 131% of nominal intensity for stage 3. This is the section the animals crossed. The remaining lights were within tolerance. The aerodrome operator's maintenance programme checks lamp serviceability but does not measure intensity.

What could not be established was whether that deviation reduced the crew's ability to see the animals. That step is an inference, and no available evidence reaches it.

Some evidence supports the inference. The pilot in command recalled the lighting as brighter than he would have wanted, a corridor of light with everything outside it black. He said that anything off the sealed surface could not be seen coming. The photometric check placed the brightest lights in the section where the animals crossed.

Other evidence weighs against it. The first officer actually saw the animals. She described the lighting as normal and said she saw them completely clearly once they were on the sealed surface, at around 200 m. She also said that, with only two daylight visits to Tarlton Springs to compare against, she was not well placed to judge whether the lighting was unusual. The pilot in command's failure to see the animals has an explanation that does not depend on the lighting: after V1 he was monitoring the engine page, as the procedure requires. In addition, nothing records what the lights were doing on the night of the occurrence, only what they measured seven days later. Nothing establishes a link between an edge light at up to 131% of nominal intensity and the detection of an object on the sealed surface.

The two accounts of the lighting are both credible, and they do not agree. The one measurement shows a deviation but not an effect. Resolving the matter would require a record of the lighting intensity on the night and evidence linking edge light intensity to detection of an object on the runway. Neither is available. The question of whether the edge lighting reduced the crew's ability to detect the animals remains unresolved.

Equipment

The strike and the loss of No. 2 reverse

The aircraft struck the animals at 07:30:33, one second after the reject began, at 114 kt. The FDR recorded a lateral acceleration spike of 0.31 g right and a vertical spike of 1.48 g.

The physical evidence matches the recorded data. Three No. 2 propeller blades were damaged beyond repairable limits, with leading edge deformation and one blade tip separated. Animal tissue was recovered from two blade roots. The right main gear doors were distorted by the impact. The lower right fuselage skin was abraded and punctured in two places, consistent with propeller debris. The gear structure was within limits on detailed inspection.

The damage had a direct effect on the stop. No. 2 propeller RPM decayed from the moment of impact. When the pilot in command selected reverse at 07:30:36, the No. 2 reverse interlock did not make, and reverse was available on the No. 1 engine only. The strike therefore removed half of the aircraft's reverse thrust two seconds into a stop that had no margin left.

The scheduled accelerate-stop figures assume symmetric reverse. The achieved mean deceleration between 07:30:34 and 07:30:44 was 2.6 m/s². That is approximately 15% below the value used in the certified accelerate-stop data for this weight and runway condition. The strike was not just damage to the aircraft. It reduced the deceleration available for the rest of the stop.

It was virtually certain that the No. 2 propeller and right main gear struck two kangaroos, and virtually certain that this contributed to the overrun.

The deceleration shortfall as one mechanism

The two causal paths met in the deceleration the aircraft actually achieved. The scheduled accelerate-stop distance of 1,780 m assumes a stop that begins at or before V1, with symmetric reverse. Neither assumption held. The stop began at 118 kt, 1,152 m along the runway, with 695 m of sealed surface remaining. It then continued with reverse on one engine only.

The stopping distance actually achieved from 118 kt was 757 m. That is the 695 m of remaining sealed surface plus the 62 m the aircraft travelled into the runway end safety area. The aircraft left the sealed surface at about 21 kt. In the graded gravel, longitudinal deceleration fell to 1.9 m/s². The aircraft stopped at 07:30:57, 28 m short of the end of the prepared safety area. Beyond that point the terrain is ungraded.

The recorded data, the distance reconstruction and the physical marks all agree. Continuous tyre marks ran from 1,160 m to the runway end, and the nose wheel rut ended 62 m into the safety area on the extended centreline.

The 62 m overrun is best understood as one mechanism, not two separate events. A stop began 6 kt late, and it then achieved approximately 15% less deceleration than the scheduled figures assume. The late start and the reduced deceleration acted together to carry the aircraft beyond the end of the sealed surface.

It was virtually certain that the deceleration achieved was below the scheduled accelerate-stop performance, and virtually certain that this contributed to the overrun.

Brakes and anti-skid

The braking system performed as designed. Brake energy absorbed was calculated at 84% of the certified maximum for the weight and speed. There was no brake fire and no hydraulic leak. The anti-skid system was tested after the occurrence and found serviceable. Both right main tyres deflated through their fuse plugs, which is consistent with the brake energy absorbed.

Cabin floor proximity emergency lighting (other factor that increased risk, Safety Issue)

The investigation also found a defect in the aircraft's emergency lighting that had no part in the occurrence. During the disembarkation, the first officer noticed unlit sections of the aisle floor strip while walking back through the cabin. A functional check on 24/06/2026, carried out with the system armed and the aircraft on battery power, found that two of the six floor proximity escape path segments on the left side aft of row 16 did not illuminate. The fault was traced to a failed ballast common to both segments.

The defect could not have been detected by any check available to the crew or a line engineer. The pre-flight emergency lighting test on this type illuminates the ceiling emergency lights and the exit signs. It neither illuminates nor monitors the floor proximity segments. The defect could be found only by a dedicated functional test. The last such test was 11 months before the occurrence, within the maintenance programme's 24-month interval.

The defect had no effect on the occurrence or on its outcome. No evacuation was commanded. The main cabin lights were on throughout. The disembarkation by the forward airstair was unhurried and took 4 minutes 8 seconds without incident.

The defect is still significant. In different circumstances, such as a fire indication, smoke, or a night evacuation over the wing, two dark segments in the aft cabin could make the difference between an orderly exit and a blocked one. The central problem is the monitoring regime. A 24-month interval on a system the daily test cannot see means the true state of the fleet's floor proximity lighting is unknown. The same ballast is fitted across the type.

It was virtually certain that the cabin floor proximity emergency lighting was partially unserviceable. It was unlikely that this contributed to the occurrence, and very likely that it increased risk.

Procedures

The runway inspection requirement and its listing criterion

The operator had a procedure designed for exactly this hazard. Operations Manual Part A 8.14.1 states that "Wildlife presents a hazard to aircraft operations, particularly at regional aerodromes and particularly around dawn and dusk." Section 8.14.2 then requires that, at an aerodrome listed in Appendix 8A, "the pilot in command shall request a runway inspection from the aerodrome operator prior to the first departure after last light, and shall not commence the take-off roll until the result of that inspection has been passed."

The defence is sound in what it requires. It failed because of how an aerodrome comes to be covered by it. At aerodromes not on the list, 8.14.3 states that "no specific action is required." Appendix 8A lists an aerodrome only "where a wildlife strike involving a company aircraft has been reported at that aerodrome within the preceding 24 months."

On 18/06/2026 the appendix listed nine aerodromes. Tarlton Springs was not among them and had never been listed. The list was last reviewed on 03/03/2025, about four months before the evening service began. Nothing in Part A allows an aerodrome to be listed on any evidence other than a reported strike. Nothing in Part A asks crews to report sightings. The aerodrome's own sighting log was not reported to any operator, and no airline had ever asked to see it.

The result was that the defence could only be switched on by the outcome it existed to prevent. Tarlton Springs had had no company strike, so it could not be listed. Because it was not listed, no inspection was required. Because no inspection was required, none was requested. The eleven recorded sightings of kangaroos on the sealed surface of runway 09/27 could not put the aerodrome on the list, because they were not strikes and had not been reported to the company.

The influence of this gap was assessed as very likely. If the requirement had applied, an inspection would have been requested, and the take-off would not have started until a clear result was passed. The aerodrome's staff disperse animals when they find them. The investigation allowed for the fact that an inspection completed some minutes before departure does not guarantee a clear runway at the start of the roll.

It was virtually certain that the operator's procedures required a runway inspection only at aerodromes listed in Appendix 8A, with listing triggered only by a reported strike, and very likely that this contributed to no runway inspection being requested before the departure (Safety Issue).

Rejected take-off guidance and training

Part B 4.6 sets out the operator's rejected take-off policy. Below 80 kt, the take-off is rejected for any condition the pilot in command judges makes the aircraft unfit to fly. Between 80 kt and V1, 4.6.3 limits the reject to "fire or fire warning; engine failure; a configuration warning; loss of directional control; or the pilot in command's judgement that the aircraft is unsafe or unable to fly." At or above V1, 4.6.4 requires the take-off to be continued. The section contains no guidance on an obstruction seen on the runway at any speed. It also gives no further guidance on 4.6.4 for a case in which continuing is itself hazardous.

Training matched the manual. Recurrent training syllabus TRG-SYL-07 module 4 contains four scripted simulator scenarios. These are an engine failure at 90 kt, an engine fire at 100 kt, a configuration warning at 85 kt, and an engine failure at V1 plus 5 kt, in which the take-off is continued. Every scenario is an aircraft system event. Three are below V1, and the fourth is a continued take-off. None presents an obstruction, an animal or any other external hazard on the runway.

The company's records show that 214 crew completed module 4 in the 2025 to 2026 cycle. No crew had been presented with an external obstruction scenario in the five cycles held on file. Records before those five cycles were not available. For that reason the existence of this gap is put at extremely likely rather than virtually certain. Both the pilot in command and the first officer stated independently, and in almost the same words, that every stop or go scenario they had been given had involved an engine and had arrived below V1.

The investigation weighed two readings of how this gap influenced the decision.

On the first reading, the pilot in command had two seconds to decide and nothing in his training to draw on. The decision he made was the first time he had considered the question at all.

Preventing that situation is the purpose of training. A decision made without rehearsal in two seconds is not the same as a decision made against a briefed and practised framework.

On the second reading, the pilot in command stated plainly that he knew the procedure and departed from it deliberately. He did not reject because he was untrained. He rejected because he judged that continuing was the worse option. On this reading, training on obstructions would not have changed what he knew, and the training gap is a finding about the fleet rather than a cause of this reject.

The investigation accepted the first reading on the balance of the evidence, and assessed the influence as likely rather than higher. The second reading carries real weight and is not dismissed. This finding explains the circumstances in which the decision was made. It does not excuse the decision, and it does not imply that training would have produced a different outcome.

It was extremely likely that the operator's rejected take-off training and guidance covered aircraft system failures below V1 only, and likely that this contributed to the take-off being rejected 6 kt above V1 (Safety Issue).

Organisation

Change management for the evening service

The current route risk assessment for Tarlton Springs is RRA-041 issue 3, dated 11/2022. It assessed the runway length and accelerate-stop margin, the single runway with no lighting redundancy, the absence of an alternate within 200 nm at night, limited engineering support, and summer heat and density altitude. It carried the operating restriction "daylight operations only pending review of night lighting and diversion fuel policy". Issue 3 is the current issue, and no issue 4 exists.

Change Management Record CMR-2025-118 introduced the evening service. It added one evening rotation, Sydney to Tarlton Springs to Sydney, six days per week, from 14/07/2025. This was the first company operation into Tarlton Springs after last light.

The record assessed the change as "schedule change only". It noted "Existing aerodrome, existing aircraft type, existing crew qualifications, existing engineering support arrangements. No new hazard identified." It answered "No" to whether a route risk assessment review was required. The Head of Flying Operations approved the change on 22/05/2025.

CMR-2025-118 does not mention the daylight-only restriction anywhere, and RRA-041 was not reopened. The Safety Department's records show no involvement in the change beyond receiving the approved record.

The approval and the decision not to review the route risk assessment are documented, and nothing contradicts them. Why the change was assessed this way is not known. The approver has since left the company and could not be interviewed. The investigation therefore draws no conclusion about the reasoning behind the assessment. Its finding concerns the process.

The process asked whether the change was new. It did not ask whether the existing assessment still held. As a result, a company aircraft operated into an aerodrome after last light for the first time while a current restriction against that operation was in place.

The influence of this factor was assessed as likely, not higher. A review of RRA-041 against a night operation would have reached the aerodrome's wildlife exposure and the Appendix 8A listing in the same review. That cannot be stated with certainty. The restriction names only night lighting and diversion fuel, and a review might have addressed those alone. The approver also cannot be asked what information was in front of him.

It was virtually certain that the evening service was approved as a schedule change without the route risk assessment being reopened, and likely that this contributed to the absence of any wildlife control for the operation after last light (Safety Issue).

Deferral of the perimeter fence repair

The failure of the northern fence was known to the aerodrome operator for more than three years before the occurrence. Works register item WR-221, raised in 04/2023, recorded four displaced panels and strained wire on the northern boundary between the 700 m and 1,300 m runway markers. It also recorded that animals had been observed passing through. Replacement was estimated at \$41,000.

The repair was deferred at the 2023, 2024 and 2025 budget rounds. Each time it was recorded as unfunded and to be reviewed at the next cycle. Item WR-263, raised in 02/2026, recorded that the same section was deteriorating further.

The investigator's site inspection on 23/06/2026 found a continuous 140 m section of the northern fence with the bottom two wires separated from the posts. There was a clear animal pad through the fence at the 1,050 m mark (Figure 1).



Figure 1: The northern perimeter fence at the 1,050 m mark, photographed on the site visit: the fallen section and the animal pad through it. Site inspection photograph SV-2026-0417-07, northern boundary at the 1,050 m runway marker, taken 23/06/2026

The breach is the most likely physical route by which the animals reached the movement area. The pad at 1,050 m lies on the northern side, the same side from which the animals crossed and on which the carcasses were recovered at 1,188 m and 1,221 m. A fence in the condition found does not exclude kangaroos. The animal pad was directly upstream of the strike position. Nothing in this

sequence had to be reconstructed. The aerodrome operator's own register records the failure, the observation of animals passing through, and each deferral.

It was virtually certain that the perimeter fence repair was deferred for three budget cycles, and very likely that this contributed to the two kangaroos entering the runway strip and moving onto the sealed surface (Safety Issue).

The wildlife planning threshold in the aerodrome standard

Aerodrome Standard AS-139 section 10.4 governs wildlife hazard management. Section 10.4.1 requires the operator of a certified aerodrome to "take reasonable measures to reduce the risk to aircraft operations presented by wildlife on or in the vicinity of the aerodrome."

Section 10.4.2 requires a documented wildlife hazard management plan only where the aerodrome "is used by aeroplanes having a maximum take-off weight exceeding 27,000 kg, or serves more than 350,000 passenger movements in a calendar year." Where 10.4.2 does not apply, 10.4.3 provides that the measures "need not be documented, but the aerodrome operator must be able to demonstrate what measures are in place."

Tarlton Springs is a certified aerodrome. Its heaviest scheduled aeroplane is the 22,900 kg twin-turboprop used on the Saltbush Air service. It handled 61,400 passenger movements in 2025. Neither limb of 10.4.2 applies. The aerodrome accordingly held no plan, no hazard assessment and no dispersal programme. It held no record of wildlife measures beyond the single inspection before the first arrival under Aerodrome Manual 6.3. This was confirmed against the certified aerodrome register and the aerodrome operator's own compliance file. The aerodrome was not in breach of the standard.

This is a finding about the standard, not about compliance. The standard's own threshold leaves an aerodrome of this size with a wildlife programme that is undocumented, unaudited and, in practice, unfunded.

The investigation weighed the arguments on this factor's influence, and the balance is closer than for the other organisational factors.

Arguments for influence: A documented plan is the one mechanism that would have connected the aerodrome's sighting log to the operators using the aerodrome. It is also the mechanism that would have placed the failed fence on a funded programme rather than leaving it on an unfunded works register. A documented plan brings an audit trail and an owner. Every other control in this occurrence failed for want of exactly those.

Arguments against influence: Section 10.4.1 still obliged the aerodrome operator to take reasonable measures. A documented plan is not the only way to repair a fence or to pass a sighting log to an airline. The council's deferrals were budget decisions. There is no evidence that a documented plan would have been funded any better. A plan is a document, and repairing the fence required money.

The investigation accepted the first argument on the balance of the evidence. It assessed the influence as likely, which is a lower degree of confidence than for the other contributing factors. This finding should be read with that qualification.

It was virtually certain that AS-139 required a documented wildlife hazard management plan only above a size threshold that Tarlton Springs does not meet. It was likely that this contributed to the fence repair remaining unfunded and to the operator's wildlife control not being triggered at the aerodrome (Safety Issue).

Excluded hypotheses

Two hypotheses were tested and excluded.

The first was that the take-off began with a tailwind above limits. It was tested because a stop ending 62 m past the runway end raises that question. The 06:30, 07:00 and 08:00 UTC observations gave winds of 090 at 7, 090 at 6 and 090 at 5 kt, a headwind component of 5 to 7 kt on runway 09. The recorded FDR wind during the roll gave a headwind component of 4 to 6 kt throughout, with no tailwind component at any point. The crew's performance calculation used a 5 kt headwind, which is consistent with both sources. It was very unlikely that a tailwind existed at any stage of the roll.

The second was that the No. 2 engine lost power during the take-off roll. It was tested because a reject at high speed is most commonly an engine event. The FDR recorded both engines at take-off torque, 98.4% and 98.5%, within 0.1% of each other, from power set at 07:30:02 until the power levers were retarded at 07:30:32. Fuel flow, ITT and propeller RPM on both engines were within normal scatter, and no caution, warning or exceedance was recorded before the reject. The CVR contains no engine-related call before the reject. The pilot in command's first words were "Stopping. I have control.", one second after the first officer's sighting call. Borescope inspection of both engines found no pre-existing damage. The No. 2 propeller damage and RPM decay both began at 07:30:33, at the moment of impact and after the reject. The No. 2 power loss was a consequence of the strike, not a cause of the reject. It was very unlikely that a No. 2 engine power loss occurred during the take-off roll before the reject.

Findings summary

A finding stated without a likelihood term was established as fact.

Contributing factors

- Under AS-139 10.4.2, a documented wildlife hazard management plan was required only above a size threshold that Tarlton Springs Aerodrome did not meet. This was virtually certain, and it was likely that the absence of a documented plan contributed to the occurrence. (Safety Issue)
- The repair of the northern perimeter fence was deferred for three budget cycles, which was virtually certain, and the deferral very likely contributed to the occurrence. (Safety Issue)
- It was very likely that the departure took place in the hour after last light, the peak period of kangaroo movement recorded at the aerodrome, and this condition likely contributed to the occurrence.
- The operator approved the evening service as a schedule change and did not reopen the route risk assessment. This was virtually certain, and it likely contributed to the occurrence. (Safety Issue)
- The operator's procedures required a runway inspection only at listed aerodromes, and the only criterion for listing was a reported wildlife strike. This was virtually certain, and it very likely contributed to the occurrence. (Safety Issue)
- No runway inspection was requested before the first departure after last light. This was virtually certain, and it was likely that the absence of an inspection contributed to the occurrence.
- Two kangaroos entered the runway strip and moved onto the sealed surface, which was virtually certain, and their presence very likely contributed to the occurrence.
- It was very likely that the operator's rejected take-off training covered only aircraft system failures below V1, and the limits of that training likely contributed to the occurrence. (Safety Issue)
- The take-off was rejected 6 kt above V1, which was virtually certain, and the late reject very likely contributed to the occurrence.
- The No. 2 propeller and right main gear struck two kangaroos, which was virtually certain, and the strike contributed to the occurrence with virtual certainty.
- The deceleration achieved was below the scheduled accelerate-stop performance. This was virtually certain, and the shortfall contributed to the occurrence with virtual certainty.

Other factors that increased risk

- Two of the cabin floor proximity emergency lighting segments were unserviceable, which was virtually certain, and it was very likely that this condition increased risk. (Safety Issue)
- The flight was the crew's fifth sector, 11 hours into the duty and 40 minutes behind schedule. This was virtually certain, and it was likely that this exposure increased risk.

Other findings

- A take-off commenced with a tailwind above limits was examined and ruled out.
- A No. 2 engine power loss during the take-off roll was examined and ruled out.

- The application of maximum braking and No. 1 reverse without delay was examined and found to have reduced risk.

Appendices

Appendix A: Summary of factor testing

Each factor examined in the analysis was tested in three stages. The first stage asked whether the factor existed. The second asked whether it influenced the occurrence. The third, applied where a factor did not influence the occurrence, asked whether it was nonetheless important to safety. The table below gives each factor's lane, the result and likelihood term at each stage, and the category that resulted. Where a stage was not reached, it is shown as not tested.

Factor	Lane	Existence	Influence	Importance	Category
Documented wildlife plan required only above a size threshold the aerodrome does not meet	External Influences	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, likely	Not tested	Contributing factor (Safety Issue)
Perimeter fence repair deferred for three budget cycles	Organisational Influences	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, very likely	Not tested	Contributing factor (Safety Issue)
Evening service approved as a schedule change, route risk assessment not reopened	Organisational Influences	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, likely	Not tested	Contributing factor (Safety Issue)
Runway inspection required only at listed aerodromes, and the listing criterion is a strike	Risk Controls	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, very likely	Not tested	Contributing factor (Safety Issue)
Rejected take-off training covers aircraft system failures below V1 only	Risk Controls	Pass, extremely likely	Pass, likely	Not tested	Contributing factor (Safety Issue)
Departure in the hour after last light, the peak of kangaroo movement	Local Conditions	Pass, extremely likely	Pass, likely	Not tested	Contributing factor
No runway inspection requested before the first departure after last light	Individual Actions	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, likely	Not tested	Contributing factor
Take-off rejected 6 kt above V1	Individual Actions	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, extremely likely	Not tested	Contributing factor
Two kangaroos entered the runway strip and moved onto the sealed surface	Occurrence Events	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, extremely likely	Not tested	Contributing factor
No. 2 propeller and right main gear struck two kangaroos	Occurrence Events	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, virtually certain	Not tested	Contributing factor
Deceleration achieved below the scheduled	Occurrence Events	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, virtually certain	Not tested	Contributing factor

accelerate-stop performance					
Cabin floor proximity emergency lighting partially unserviceable	Risk Controls	Pass, virtually certain	Fail, unlikely	Pass, very likely	Other factor that increased risk (Safety Issue)
Fifth sector, 11 hours into duty, 40 minutes behind schedule	Local Conditions	Pass, virtually certain	Fail, unlikely	Pass, likely	Other factor that increased risk
Maximum braking and No. 1 reverse applied without delay	Individual Actions	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, very likely (decreased risk)	Not tested	Other finding (reduced risk)
Take-off commenced with a tailwind above limits	Local Conditions	Fail, very unlikely	Not tested	Not tested	Excluded
No. 2 engine power loss during the take-off roll	Occurrence Events	Fail, very unlikely	Not tested	Not tested	Excluded
Runway edge lighting intensity reduced the crew's ability to detect the animals	Local Conditions	Inconclusive, about as likely as not	Not tested	Not tested	Unresolved (no finding)

The runway edge lighting matter could not be settled and is not a finding. A photometric check on 25/06/2026, seven days after the occurrence, measured four northern edge lights between the 900 m and 1,200 m markers at 118% to 131% of nominal for stage 3. That deviation is established. Whether it reduced the crew's ability to detect the animals is an inference that the available evidence does not reach. The pilot in command recalled the lighting as brighter than he would want, with everything outside it black. The first officer, who saw the animals, described the lighting as normal and said she saw them clearly once they were on the sealed surface, though she also said that, having previously landed there only in daylight, she was not well placed to judge. The pilot in command was looking at the engine page after V1, as the procedure required, which explains his not seeing the animals without reference to the lighting. No measurement exists of the lights on the night, and no established link was found between an edge light at 131% of nominal and the detection of an object on the runway. Resolving the matter would require evidence of the lighting's actual condition on 18/06/2026 and a basis for relating that intensity to detection of an object on the sealed surface.

Appendix B: Excluded hypotheses

Take-off commenced with a tailwind above limits

This hypothesis was tested because the length of the overrun raised a question about the wind. The aerodrome observations at 06:30, 07:00 and 08:00 UTC gave 090 at 7 kt, 090 at 6 kt and 090 at 5 kt, a headwind component of 5 to 7 kt on runway 09. The recorded flight data gave a headwind component of 4 to 6 kt throughout the roll, with no tailwind component at any point. The crew's performance entry used a 5 kt headwind, which matched both. No source showed a tailwind at any stage of the roll, and the hypothesis was found very unlikely and excluded.

No. 2 engine power loss during the take-off roll

This hypothesis was tested because a reject at 118 kt is most commonly associated with an engine event. The flight data recorded both engines at 98.4% and 98.5% torque, within 0.1% of each other, from power set at 07:30:02 until the power levers were retarded at 07:30:32. Fuel flow, ITT and propeller RPM on both engines stayed inside normal scatter throughout. No caution, warning or

exceedance was recorded before the reject. The cockpit voice recording contained no engine-related call, and the pilot in command's first words after the first officer's sighting call announced the stop. Borescope inspection of both engines found no pre-existing damage. The No. 2 propeller damage and RPM decay both began at 07:30:33, at the moment of impact and after the reject had begun. The No. 2 power loss was therefore a consequence of the strike and not a cause of the reject. The hypothesis was found very unlikely and excluded.

Appendix C: Sources of evidence

Interviews and accounts

- The pilot in command, interviewed and recorded, with the interview completed by 26/06/2026. The pilot in command also submitted an air safety report. [NOT ESTABLISHED: date of the pilot in command's air safety report]
- The first officer, interviewed and recorded, with the interview completed by 26/06/2026.
- The aerodrome reporting officer, who provided information during the site visit on 23/06/2026, including confirmation that no operator had ever asked for the wildlife sighting log and that a runway inspection would have been carried out if requested.

Recorded data and audio

- Flight Data Section report FDA-2026-0417-R1, FDR and QAR readout for VH-SBQ, sector SB512, issued 24/06/2026.
- CVR-2026-0417 and tower recorded audio, 07:29 to 07:34 UTC, transcribed 25/06/2026 and verified by a second investigator.

Aircraft and site examination

- Engineering inspection report, VH-SBQ, 19/06/2026 to 21/06/2026, covering the post-occurrence aircraft inspection and runway survey.
- Functional check record, VH-SBQ cabin emergency lighting, 24/06/2026.
- Photometric check of runway 09/27 edge lighting at Tarlton Springs, 25/06/2026.
- Site inspection of the northern perimeter fence, 23/06/2026, including photograph SV-2026-0417-07 of the northern boundary at the 1,050 m runway marker (attachments/Perimeter_fence_repair_deferred_for_three_budget_cycles_1.jpg).

Weather and environment

- MET-ARCH-SB512-180626, weather observations, forecast, and light and moon data, retrieved 19/06/2026.

Aerodrome documents

- Tarlton Springs Aerodrome wildlife sighting log, 01/2025 to 06/2026, copied 23/06/2026.
- Tarlton Shire Council aerodrome works register, items WR-221 (04/2023) and WR-263 (02/2026).
- Aerodrome daily inspection log for 18/06/2026.
- Aerodrome Manual section 6.3.
- The certified aerodrome register and the aerodrome operator's compliance file.

Operator documents

- Saltbush Air Operations Manual Part A section 8.14 and Appendix 8A, revision 9, 04/2024.
- Saltbush Air Operations Manual Part B section 4.6, revision 14, 09/2025.
- Route Risk Assessment RRA-041 issue 3 (11/2022) and Change Management Record CMR-2025-118 (approved 22/05/2025).

- Recurrent training syllabus TRG-SYL-07, cycle 2025 to 2026, module 4.
- Flight crew records and duty record, 18/06/2026.

Regulatory material

- Aerodrome Standard AS-139 section 10.4, wildlife hazard management.

Appendix D: Investigation activity

All times below are UTC.

- 18/06/2026, 09:05: The investigation was notified by the Duty Operations Controller, assessed as a serious incident warranting investigation, and opened with its scope written down.
- 19/06/2026, 01:20: The recorders were removed at Tarlton Springs and dispatched to the flight data section. Both flight crew were stood down and tested, with negative results. The Head of Flying Operations suspended the evening Tarlton Springs service.
- 23/06/2026, 08:40: The site visit to Tarlton Springs took place. The northern fence was walked and photographed, and a continuous 140 m failure and an animal pad at the 1,050 m mark were found. The wildlife sighting log was copied and a photometric check of the runway 09/27 edge lighting was requested.
- 26/06/2026, 04:15: The interviews with the pilot in command and the first officer were completed. The cabin emergency lighting functional check was raised following the first officer's account.
- 02/07/2026, 06:30: The Appendix 8A listing criterion was confirmed as one that only a reported strike at an aerodrome could satisfy, with no provision asking crews to report sightings. The matter was raised with the operator's Safety Department.

Distribution

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